

The Raven

Once upon a midnight dreary, while I
pondered, weak and weary,

Over many a quaint and curious volume of
forgotten lore,

While I nodded, nearly napping, suddenly
there came a tapping,

As of some one gently rapping, rapping at my
chamber door.

"Tis some visiter," I muttered, "tapping at my
chamber door -

Only this, and nothing more."

Ah, distinctly I remember it was in the bleak
December,

And each separate dying ember wrought its
ghost upon the floor.

Eagerly I wished the morrow; - vainly I had
tried to borrow

From my books surcease of sorrow - sorrow
for the lost Lenore -

For the rare and radiant maiden whom the
angels name Lenore -

Nameless here for evermore.

And the silken sad uncertain rustling of each

purple curtain

Thrilled me - filled me with fantastic terrors
never felt before;

So that now, to still the beating of my heart,
I stood repeating

"Tis some visiter entreating entrance at my
chamber door -

Some late visiter entreating entrance at my
chamber door; -

This it is, and nothing more."

Presently my soul grew stronger; hesitating
then no longer,

"Sir," said I, "or Madam, truly your
forgiveness I implore;

But the fact is I was napping, and so gently
you came rapping,

And so faintly you came tapping, tapping at
my chamber door,

That I scarce was sure I heard you" -
here I opened wide the door; -

Darkness there, and nothing more.

Deep into that darkness peering, long I stood
there wondering, fearing,

Doubting, dreaming dreams no mortal ever

dared to dream before;

But the silence was unbroken, and the
darkness gave no token,

And the only word there spoken was the
whispered word, "Lenore!"

This I whispered, and an echo murmured
back the word, "Lenore!"

Merely this and nothing more.

Then into the chamber turning, all my soul
within me burning,

Soon I heard again a tapping somewhat
louder than before.

"Surely," said I, "surely that is something at
my window lattice;

Let me see, then, what thereat is, and this
mystery explore -

Let my heart be still a moment and this
mystery explore; -

'Tis the wind and nothing more!"